



FREE GUIDE • PUNE EDITION

The Pune Homeowner's Interior Design Guide 2026

Everything you need to know before designing your home — realistic timelines, honest costs, the right questions to ask, and the red flags to avoid.

- ✓ Realistic timelines from possession to move-in
- ✓ Honest cost benchmarks for 1BHK, 2BHK & 3BHK
- ✓ The 10 questions to ask any designer
- ✓ Red flags used by big brands

2026

3 Bricks — Interior Designers & Architects

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

A Straight-Talking Guide, Not a Sales Brochure

Most homeowners in Pune sign their first interior design contract without knowing what a realistic timeline looks like, what things actually cost, or what questions separate a good designer from a risky one. This guide exists to close that gap — no jargon, no inflated promises. Just what you need to walk into your first design conversation informed and confident.

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How to use this guide: Read it once fully before your first meeting with any designer or contractor. Then keep it handy — the questions in Section 3 are worth re-reading right before you sign a contract.

SECTION 01

Realistic Timelines

Possession day feels like the finish line, but it's really the starting gun. Here's what an honest, well-run interior project timeline looks like in Pune — from the day you get your keys to the day you move in.

PHASE 1**Possession & Site Assessment****3 - 7 days**

Measurements, electrical and plumbing checks, seepage inspection, and understanding builder handover snags before any design work begins.

PHASE 2**Design & Space Planning****2 - 4 weeks**

Layout finalisation, mood boards, 3D visualisation, material and finish selection. This is the phase most homeowners rush — and regret rushing.

PHASE 3**Approvals & Procurement****1 - 2 weeks**

Final sign-off on drawings and BOQ, material ordering, and vendor scheduling. Long-lead items (modular shutters, stone, imported fittings) are ordered here.

PHASE 4**Civil & MEP Work****3 - 5 weeks**

Electrical rewiring, plumbing changes, false ceiling framework, wall alterations, and waterproofing where required.

PHASE 5**Carpentry & Modular Execution****4 - 7 weeks**

Kitchen, wardrobes, TV units and loose furniture fabrication and installation. Usually the longest single phase of the project.

PHASE 6**Finishing, Snagging & Handover****2 - 3 weeks**

Painting, polishing, deep cleaning, snag-list resolution, and final walkthrough before you move your first box in.

Total realistic timeline: 14 - 20 weeks (3.5 - 5 months) for a full 2BHK/3BHK interior fit-out, from possession to move-in. Anyone promising a full home in 4-6 weeks is either doing very little work or cutting corners you won't see until later.

SECTION 01

What Actually Causes Delays

Timelines rarely slip because of design decisions. They slip because of a handful of predictable, avoidable causes. Knowing these in advance helps you plan around them.

1 Late material selection

Tiles, stone and hardware often have 2-3 week lead times. Deciding late pushes the whole schedule back, not just that one item.

2 Mid-project design changes

Every change after carpentry has started means rework — and rework is where both time and budget quietly disappear.

3 Society NOC and work-hour restrictions

Many Pune societies restrict contractor work hours and require move-in NOCs — factor this in before setting expectations.

4 Monsoon-season execution

Civil work, waterproofing and painting all run slower and less reliably between June and September.

SECTION 02

Honest Cost Benchmarks

Costs vary with material choices, brand selections and site conditions — but the ranges below reflect realistic, mid-to-premium interior fit-outs in Pune for 2026, based on carpet area. Use these to sanity-check any quote you receive.

1 BHK (450–600 sq.ft carpet)	₹5.5L – ₹9L
Modular Kitchen	₹1.5L – ₹2.5L
Wardrobes (2 rooms)	₹1.2L – ₹2L
False Ceiling & Electrical	₹80K – ₹1.3L
Flooring / Painting / Misc.	₹1.5L – ₹2.5L
Design & Project Management	₹50K – ₹90K

2 BHK (750–1000 sq.ft carpet)	₹9L – ₹16L
Modular Kitchen	₹2L – ₹3.5L
Wardrobes (3 rooms)	₹2L – ₹3.5L
False Ceiling & Electrical	₹1.3L – ₹2.2L
Flooring / Painting / Misc.	₹2.5L – ₹4L
Design & Project Management	₹1.2L – ₹1.8L

3 BHK (1100–1500 sq.ft carpet)	₹15L – ₹26L
Modular Kitchen	₹2.8L – ₹4.5L
Wardrobes (4 rooms)	₹3L – ₹5L
False Ceiling & Electrical	₹2L – ₹3.3L
Flooring / Painting / Misc.	₹4L – ₹6.5L
Design & Project Management	₹2L – ₹3.2L

Figures are indicative 2026 Pune-market ranges for mid-to-premium finishes and can shift based on brand choices, site condition, and scope. Always ask for an itemised BOQ (Bill of Quantities), not a lump-sum number.

SECTION 02

What Drives Cost Up — and Down

Two homes of identical size can cost very differently. Here's what typically moves the number, in either direction.

Pushes cost up

- Imported hardware & fittings
- Full-height veneer/laminate paneling
- False ceilings in every room
- Custom furniture over modular
- Natural stone flooring
- Structural layout changes

Keeps cost sensible

- Standard modular hardware brands
- Selective, not full-room, false ceilings
- Reusing existing flooring where possible
- Phased execution (kitchen + 1 room first)
- Loose furniture instead of built-in
- Keeping the original layout

A note on quotes: The single biggest reason project costs overrun is not bad estimation — it's scope that grows after work has started. Lock your scope and material list before execution begins, and treat every "let's also do this" as a formal change order with its own cost and time impact.

SECTION 03

10 Questions to Ask Any Designer

Ask these before you sign — the answers (or lack of them) tell you more than any portfolio can.

1 Is the quote itemised, or a lump sum?

An itemised BOQ protects you from hidden markups and makes comparisons meaningful.

2 What brands of plywood, hardware and laminate are included?

"Branded" means nothing without names — ask specifically.

3 What is not included in this quote?

Civil work, false ceiling, curtains and appliances are common exclusions that surface later.

4 What is the payment schedule tied to?

Payments should be linked to milestones completed, not calendar dates.

5 Who is my single point of contact during execution?

Projects without one accountable person are where communication — and quality — breaks down.

6 What's the warranty on modular work and civil work?

Reputable firms offer clear, written warranty periods — typically 1–5 years depending on scope.

7 Can I see a live or recently completed project site?

Renders always look perfect. Site visits reveal actual finish quality and site discipline.

8 How are change orders handled and priced?

You want this in writing before you need it, not negotiated mid-project under pressure.

9 What happens if the project overruns the timeline?

Ask if there's any accountability built in — this is often the clearest signal of confidence.

10 Who handles snags after handover, and for how long?

A defined post-handover snag period (usually 30–90 days) shows the firm stands behind its work.

SECTION 04

Red Flags Used by Big Brands

Scale doesn't always mean better service. Watch for these common tactics, regardless of how polished the showroom is.

! Unrealistically low headline pricing

A rock-bottom per-sq.ft. rate that later grows through "essential" add-ons is a pricing strategy, not a deal.

! High-pressure same-day discounts

"This price is only valid if you sign today" is a sales tactic designed to prevent you from comparing quotes.

! Vague material specifications

Terms like "premium quality" or "branded" without a named brand and grade are a placeholder for cost-cutting later.

! Designer changes mid-project

Large firms often rotate designers across projects — you lose continuity and design intent gets diluted.

! Payment demanded ahead of milestones

Being asked for 70-80% payment before major execution has happened shifts all the risk onto you.

! No written warranty or snag policy

If it isn't in the contract, it doesn't exist once the final payment is made.



3 BRICKS

Ready to design a home that's actually yours?

At 3 Bricks, we plan honestly, quote transparently, and stay accountable
from possession to move-in. Let's talk about your space.

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